

D685

Practical Applications of Prompt

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A hospital HR coordinator who has used the company chatbot for three months types, “Write about benefits.” The result is a generic essay. The hospital has 2,300 employees. Which revision best fixes the prompt?

- A. “Write about all benefits in complete detail.”
- B. “Write a 150-word email to new night-shift nurses summarizing their three health plan options and the enrollment deadline, in plain language.”
- C. “Write a much better essay about benefits.”
- D. “Write about benefits for 2,300 employees.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A user wanted a five-bullet summary to paste into a text message but received a 1,000-word formal report on the right topic. Which element was missing from the prompt?

- A. The output format and length.
- B. More example reports.
- C. The topic.
- D. A persona for the model.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A small-business owner asks an AI tool, “Why did my sales drop last quarter?” without sharing any data. The shop sells handmade candles and has a loyal social media following. What is the best improvement?

- A. Ask it to answer with complete certainty.
- B. Ask the same question three times and compare answers.
- C. Tell it the size of the social media following.
- D. Include monthly sales by product and any known changes (prices, suppliers, seasons), and ask for likely causes to check.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A graduate student asks, in a single prompt, for a literature review, a survey instrument, a data analysis plan, and a slide deck for a thesis on remote-work productivity. Every part of the response is shallow. The student's advisor is well known in the field. What is the best fix?

- A. Mention the advisor's reputation in the prompt.
- B. Break the work into a sequence of prompts, one deliverable each, feeding earlier results into later ones.
- C. Add "be thorough" to the same single prompt.
- D. Ask for all four parts in a shorter response.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A marketing team needs 40 product blurbs in its quirky house style. Written descriptions of the style ("fun but not silly") keep missing the mark. The team is on a paid enterprise plan. What is the best technique?

- A. Upgrade to a higher enterprise tier.
- B. Include all 40 blurbs as examples first.
- C. Include two or three approved blurbs as examples in the prompt.
- D. Add more adjectives describing the style.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A prompt contains three example question-and-answer pairs before the new question. What is this technique, and what does it mainly control?

- A. Role prompting; it sets the model's expertise.
- B. Zero-shot prompting; it adds no examples.
- C. Few-shot prompting; it steers the format and style of the answer.
- D. Fine-tuning; it permanently retrains the model.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A nonprofit wants feedback on a grant proposal from the funder’s point of view. The proposal is 12 pages and due Friday. Which prompt most directly gets that?

- A. “This is due Friday; review it quickly.”
- B. “Make this proposal perfect.”
- C. “Act as a foundation program officer. Review this proposal against these funding criteria and list the three biggest weaknesses.”
- D. “Summarize this proposal.”

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

8.

A paralegal at a 30-attorney firm asks an AI tool for five court cases supporting an argument. The tool returns five case names with perfectly formatted citations. What should the paralegal do?

- A. Use them; perfect formatting shows they are real.
- B. Look up each case in an authoritative legal database before using it.
- C. Never use AI for any legal work.
- D. Ask the AI whether the cases are real and accept its answer.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which AI output most needs outside verification before use?

- A. A specific statistic credited to a named study and year.
- B. A brainstormed list of slogan ideas.
- C. A rewording of a paragraph the user pasted in.
- D. Every output is equally unreliable.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

10.

Prompts for customer FAQ answers keep producing accurate but overly long replies. The writer changes the model, the tone, the length limit, and the examples all at once; results improve, but no one can tell why. The team's style guide dates from 2021. What is the better practice?

- A. Update the style guide first.
- B. Keep the first prompt that works and never revise it.
- C. Change all four elements again to confirm.
- D. Change one element at a time and score each output against set criteria.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team scores AI summaries from 1 to 5 on accuracy, length, and tone, weighting each equally. Prompt A scores 5, 2, 4. Prompt B scores 4, 4, 4. Which prompt performs better?

- A. Prompt A, because it has the only 5.
- B. A tie at 11.
- C. They cannot be compared without a fourth criterion.
- D. Prompt B, 12 to 11.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A science teacher asks an image-generation tool, "Write me a 500-word explanation of photosynthesis with a diagram." The result is a picture full of garbled text. The school has a one-laptop-per-student program. What should she change?

- A. Use a text model for the explanation, and give the image tool a visual description, such as "a labeled diagram of a leaf with sunlight, water, and carbon dioxide going in and oxygen coming out."
- B. Ask the image tool for 1,000 words instead.
- C. Wait until every student has a laptop.
- D. Add "please" and try again.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A hospital HR coordinator ~~who has used the company chatbot for three months~~ types, “Write about benefits.” The result is a generic essay. ~~The hospital has 2,300 employees.~~ Which revision best fixes the prompt?

Target word: best revision **Decides:** The prompt lacks audience, task focus, and format.

A	Absolute language	Broadens the scope and makes the output longer, not more useful.
B	Correct	Names audience, content, format, length, and tone.
C	Dropped element	Still no audience, format, or focus.
D	Camouflage	Headcount does not tell the model what to write.

2. Answer A Concept 1 · transfer

A user wanted a five-bullet summary to paste into a text message but received a 1,000-word formal report on the right topic. Which element was missing from the prompt?

Target word: missing element — reversed from output **Decides:** Topic was right; form and length were wrong.

A	Correct	Specifying “five bullets for a text message” would fix it.
B	Inverted operation	Report examples would push further toward the wrong format.
C	Adjacent category	The topic was correct.
D	Confusion set	A role shapes viewpoint, not length and format.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A small-business owner asks an AI tool, “Why did my sales drop last quarter?” without sharing any data. ~~The shop sells handmade candles and has a loyal social media following.~~ What is the best improvement?

Target word: what to add **Decides:** The model has no access to the shop’s sales.

A	Absolute language	Demanding certainty does not supply facts.
B	Dropped element	Still no data; repeats guesses.
C	Camouflage	Echoes a stem detail that does not explain the drop.
D	Correct	Relevant context lets the model reason about this shop.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A graduate student asks, in a single prompt, for a literature review, a survey instrument, a data analysis plan, and a slide deck for a thesis on remote-work productivity. Every part of the response is shallow. ~~The student’s advisor is well known in the field.~~ What is the best fix?

Target word: fix a shallow multi-part response **Decides:** Four large deliverables in one prompt.

A	Camouflage	Does not change the scope problem.
B	Correct	Focused scope gets depth on each part.
C	Dropped element	Keeps the overloaded scope.
D	Inverted operation	Less room makes each part shallower.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A marketing team needs 40 product blurbs in its quirky house style. Written descriptions of the style (“fun but not silly”) keep missing the mark. ~~The team is on a paid enterprise plan.~~ What is the best technique?

Target word: technique for style **Decides:** Descriptions fail; examples are needed.

A	Camouflage	The plan does not decide style matching.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the output count; a few good examples suffice, and the 40 don’t exist yet.
C	Correct	Few-shot examples show the style directly.
D	Adjacent category	Still zero-shot description, which is already failing.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A prompt contains three example question-and-answer pairs before the new question. What is this technique, and what does it mainly control?

Target word: name and purpose — reversed **Decides:** Examples inside the prompt.

A	Confusion set	Role prompting assigns a persona, not examples.
B	Inverted operation	Zero-shot means no examples.
C	Correct	Examples set the pattern the model follows.
D	Adjacent category	Examples in a prompt do not change model weights.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A nonprofit wants feedback on a grant proposal from the funder’s point of view. ~~The proposal is 12 pages and due Friday.~~ Which prompt most directly gets that?

Target word: technique for perspective **Decides:** Needs the funder’s viewpoint and criteria.

A	Camouflage	The deadline does not supply the funder’s view.
B	Absolute language	Vague, and gives no viewpoint.
C	Correct	The role sets the perspective; criteria and output are specified.
D	Adjacent category	A summary is not a funder’s critique.

8. Answer B Concept 6

~~A paralegal at a 30-attorney firm~~ asks an AI tool for five court cases supporting an argument. The tool returns five case names with perfectly formatted citations. What should the paralegal do?

Target word: handling cited facts **Decides:** Models can invent plausible citations.

A	Camouflage	Formatting quality says nothing about accuracy.
B	Correct	Specific citations must be verified at the source.
C	Absolute language	AI can help with drafting when facts are checked.
D	Dropped element	Drops outside verification; the model may confirm its own error.

9. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

Which AI output most needs outside verification before use?

Target word: highest hallucination risk — reversed **Decides:** Specific factual claims attributed to a source.

A	Correct	Specific facts and sources are where fabrication does harm.
B	Adjacent category	Creative options make no factual claims.
C	Inverted operation	The source is in the prompt; it can be compared directly.
D	Absolute language	Risk depends on whether the output asserts checkable facts.

10. Answer D Concept 7

Prompts for customer FAQ answers keep producing accurate but overly long replies. The writer changes the model, the tone, the length limit, and the examples all at once; results improve, but no one can tell why. ~~The team's style guide dates from 2021.~~ What is the better practice?

Target word: refinement method **Decides:** Many variables changed at once.

A	Camouflage	The guide's age does not decide the testing method.
B	Absolute language	Stops learning and cannot adapt later.
C	Inverted operation	Repeats the confound.
D	Correct	Isolates which change caused the improvement.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A team scores AI summaries from 1 to 5 on accuracy, length, and tone, weighting each equally. Prompt A scores 5, 2, 4. Prompt B scores 4, 4, 4. Which prompt performs better?

Target word: compare against criteria **Decides:** A totals 11; B totals 12.

A	Dropped element	Drops the other criteria.
B	Wrong stem number	Miscounts B's total.
C	Adjacent category	Three defined criteria are enough to compare.
D	Correct	$4 + 4 + 4 = 12$ beats $5 + 2 + 4 = 11$.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A science teacher asks an image-generation tool, "Write me a 500-word explanation of photosynthesis with a diagram." The result is a picture full of garbled text. ~~The school has a one-laptop-per-student program.~~ What should she change?

Target word: medium adjustment **Decides:** Long text was requested from an image tool.

A	Correct	Each medium gets a prompt it can fulfill.
B	Wrong stem number	More text makes the image worse.
C	Camouflage	Devices do not decide the tool mismatch.
D	Dropped element	Leaves the medium mismatch in place.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Specificity: task, audience, format	A strong prompt names the task, the audience, and the output format and length.	Asking for “better” or “more” without saying what, for whom, or in what form.	A generic output from a one-line prompt.
2	Supply the context	The model only knows what is in the prompt (and its general training); give the relevant facts and data it needs.	Expecting the model to know your private situation.	A question about “my” sales, team, or files with no data attached.
3	Scope and decomposition	Break large, multi-part requests into a sequence of focused prompts.	Cramming everything into one prompt and adding “be thorough.”	One prompt asking for several big deliverables.
4	Few-shot examples	Showing a few input-output examples steers format and style better than describing them.	Piling on adjectives instead of examples.	A house style that descriptions keep missing.
5	Role (persona) prompting	Assigning a role sets the perspective and criteria the model applies.	Asking for a summary when a critique from a specific viewpoint is needed.	“From the funder’s / reviewer’s point of view.”
6	Hallucination and verification	Models can produce confident, well-formatted but false facts and citations; verify specifics against authoritative sources.	Trusting polish, or asking the model to verify itself.	Specific citations, statistics, or names in the output.
7	Iterative refinement and evaluation	Define criteria, change one prompt element at a time, and compare outputs against the criteria.	Changing many things at once, or stopping at the first improvement.	Results improved but no one knows why.
8	Match the prompt to the medium	Choose the right tool and phrasing for the output medium (text, image, table, slide), and describe visuals visually.	Asking an image model for long text, or vice versa.	Garbled text in an image, or a prose answer where a table was needed.

Course scope (public description): The Practical Applications of Prompt course introduces learners to generative artificial intelligence (AI). This course aims to allow learners to gain skills for writing effective prompts and develop more effective conversations with artificial intelligence. Practical Applications of Prompt will lead learners to explore why prompt engineering is necessary. The course also aims to help learners, regardless of background, increase prompt fluency, which is fluency in using prompt effectively. The course teaches learners how to create effective prompts to elicit information with consideration of scope, specificity, and context; additionally, it teaches learners to evaluate the medium of the prompt and adjust prompts to output relevant results. The last section of the course focuses on ways to evaluate the efficacy of prompts and improve the depth and quality of analytical investigations. This approach prepares students to navigate the complexities of working with generative AI and use these skills effectively throughout their careers.